Ahmedabad (886 km) 3. Mumbai–Nagpur (753 km) 4. Mumbai–Hyderabad (711 km) 5. Chennai–Mysore (435 km) 6. Delhi–Amritsar (459 km) 7. Varanasi–Howrah (760 km). Of these, by August 2021, the DPR for the Delhi–Varanasi route was the most advanced and in its final stages. It envisaged a Delhi–Varanasi journey by bullet train in four hours. Ayodhya is one of the twelve stations on the route (Sarai Kale Khan, Noida, Jewar, Mathura, Agra, Etawah, Kannauj, Lucknow, Ayodhya, Raebareli, Prayagraj, Bhadohi, Varanasi) with the Delhi–Ayodhya leg planned in two hours. Details on planned high speed corridors from Vinod Kumar Yadav, Chairman NHRSCL in 'Chairman's Address', 28 September 2020, *National High Speed Rail Corporation Limited Annual Report 2019-20,* p. 4, https://nhsrcl.in/index.php/en/about-us/annual-report. Details on Delhi–Ayodhya leg as part of the proposed Delhi–Varanasi corridor from Aaj Tak, 'Bullet train se jaa sakenge Ayodhya, Delhi–Varanasi ke beech honge yeh 12 station', 12 August 2021, https://www.aajtak.in/india/news/video/delhi-varanasi-corridor-dpr-for-ayoodhya-and-kashi-by-bullet-train-1308464-2021-08-12?jwsource=cl; Also see Dipak Dash, 'Bullet train to link Delhi and Agra', *The Times of India*, 8 December 2020, https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/india/bullet-train-to-link-delhi-and-ayodhya/articleshow/79611962.cms.

17. For an analysis of Chinese soft power projection, see, for example, Joshua Kurlantzick, *Charm Offensive: How China's Soft Power Is Transforming the World* (New York: Yale University Press, 2007); Hongyi Lai, Yiyi Lu (eds), *China's Soft Power and International Relations* (London, New York: Routledge, 2012); Parama Sinha Palit, *Analysing China's Soft Power Strategies and Comparative Indian Initiatives* (New Delhi: Sage, 2017).
18. UN, 'International Day of Yoga', 21 June 2020, https://www.un.org/en/observances/yoga-day.
19. See, for instance, the book by Modi's foreign minister, S. Jaishankar: *The Indian Way: Strategies for an Uncertain World* (New Delhi: HarperCollins, 2020).
20. BJP, *Political Resolution Passed in BJP National Executive Meeting at Dr Ambedkar International Centre, 15 Janpath, New*